
Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey

65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

SOURCE

survey.stackoverflow.co/2024/work

DATE

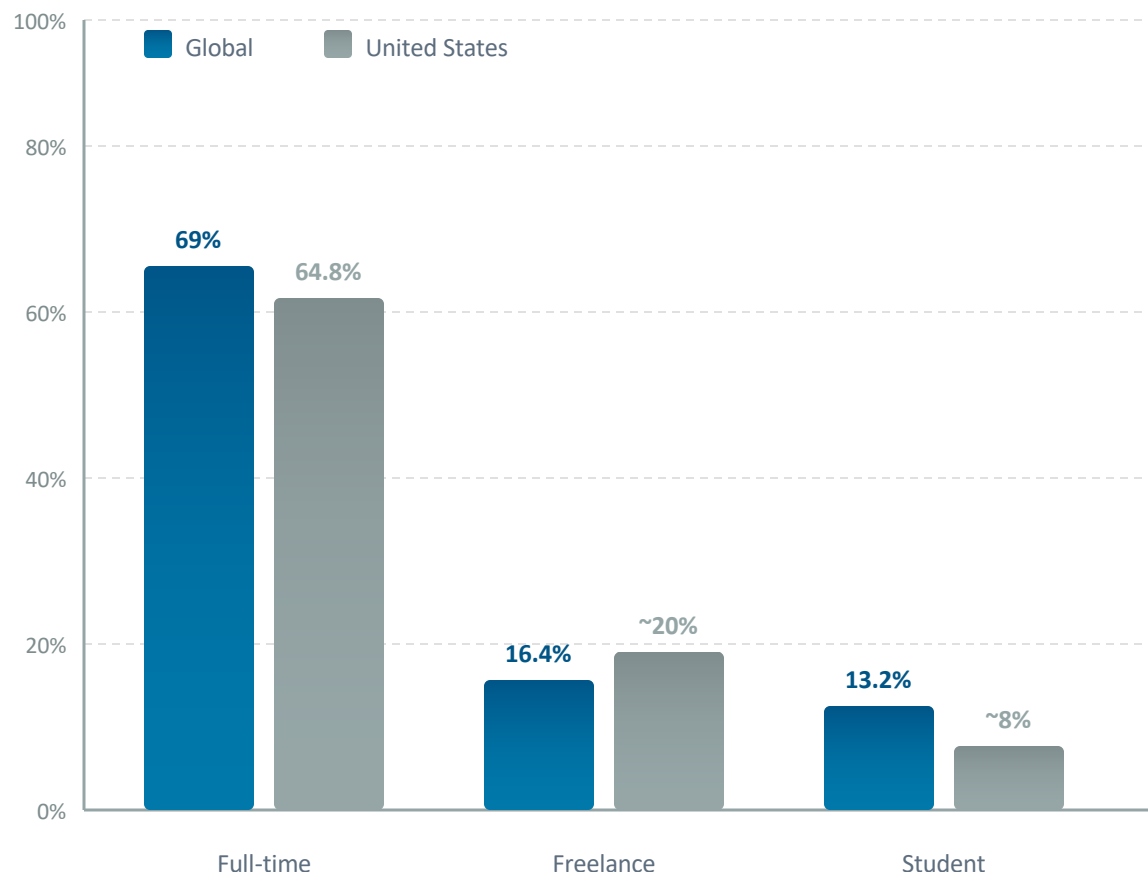
2024

CONFIDENTIAL

01 84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

Employment Status

KEY INSIGHT U.S. full-time employment fell 4.2 percentage points YoY — from 69% to 64.8% — while freelancing remains significant globally at 16.4%



 Currently Working
84% of respondents

 U.S. Full-Time Drop
-4.2pp YoY (69% → 64.8%)

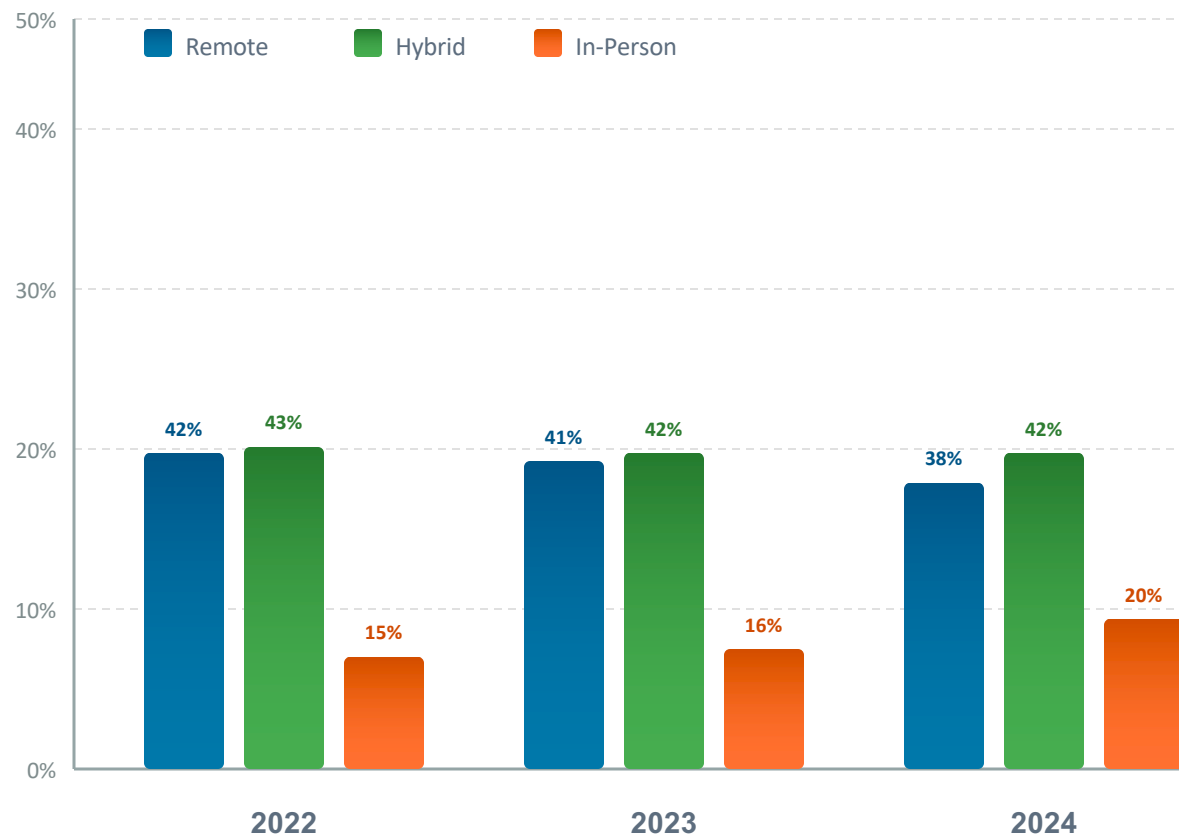
 Freelance / Contracting
16.4% of global respondents

Regional Variation

U.K. & Ukraine: non-full-time lean toward independent contracting. Germany & India: more likely to be full-time students.

KEY INSIGHT

In-person work has risen for the 3rd consecutive year (15% → 16% → 20%), signaling a gradual return-to-office trend



Hybrid Work

42% consistent with 2023

In-Person Growth

+5pp since 2022 (15% → 20%)

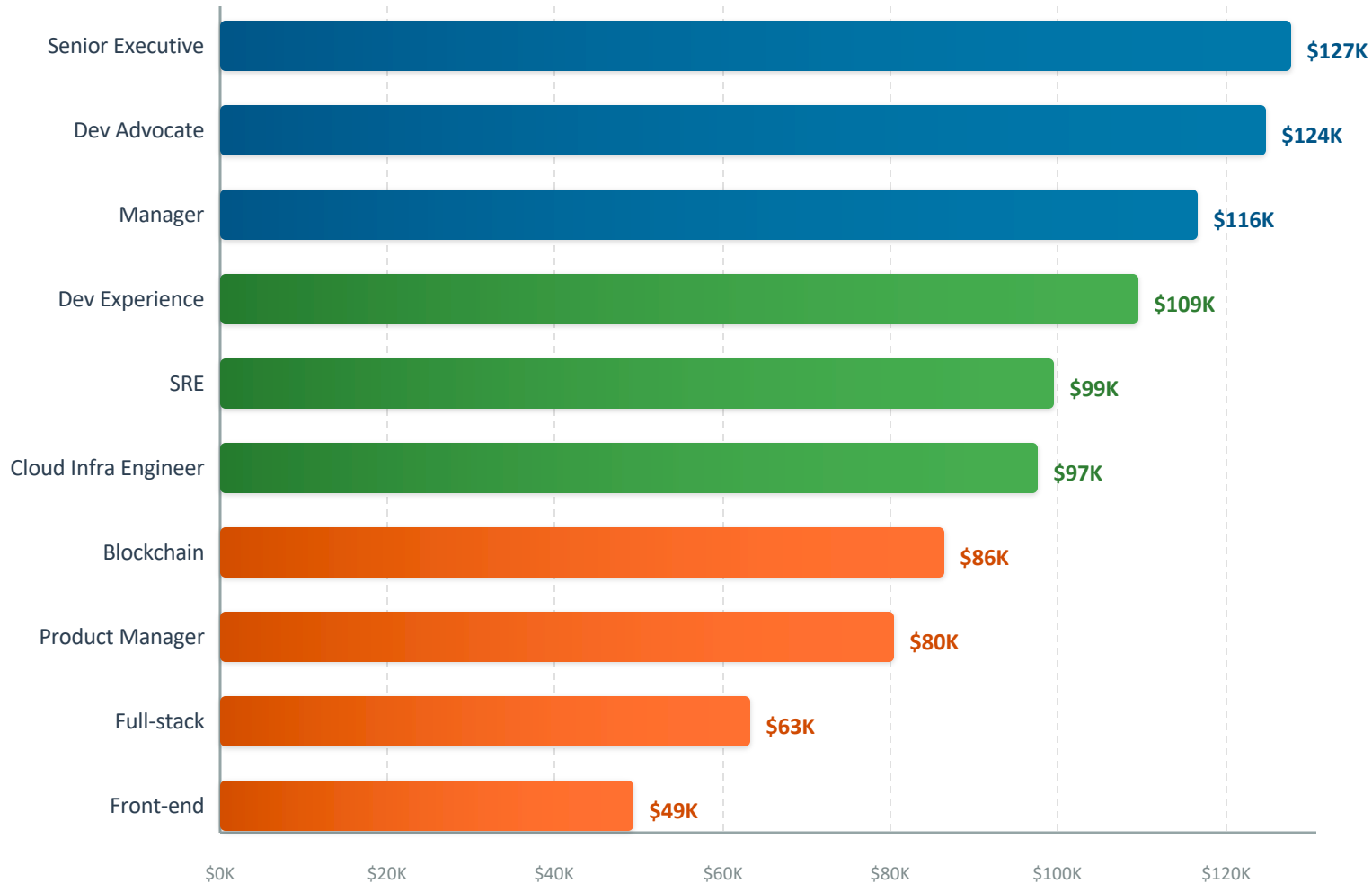
Remote Work

38% declining from 42% in 2022**Implication for Employers**

Hybrid remains dominant but in-person mandates are growing — design workplace policies for flexibility.

KEY INSIGHT

SRE and Cloud Infra are the highest-paid purely technical roles; salary range spans 8x from Student (\$15K) to Senior Executive (\$127K)

**Key Observations****Highest-paid technical roles:**

SRE (\$99K) and Cloud Infra (\$97K) reflect critical infrastructure value

8x salary gap:

Senior Exec \$127K vs. Student \$15K

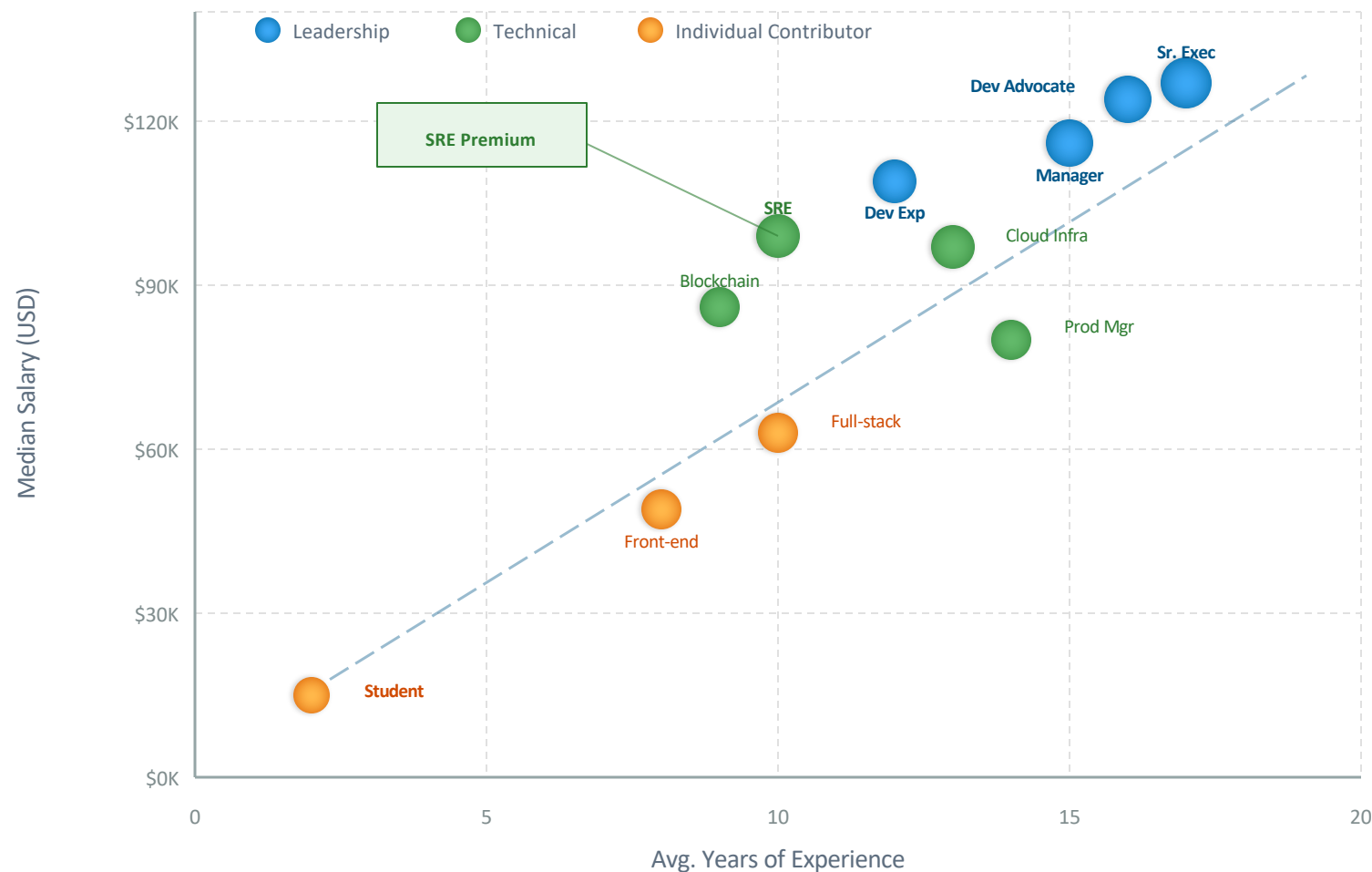
Regional variation:

Mobile devs earn more in the U.S.; data engineers top Germany/Ukraine; back-end devs lead in India/U.K.

Survey response rate:22,677 salary responses
(34.7% of total respondents)**Reference**See figure_1.jpg for original chart
from Stack Overflow Survey

KEY INSIGHT

Senior roles cluster in the upper-right (high experience + high pay); SRE stands out as a technical role with premium pay relative to experience

**Key Observations****Senior cluster (upper-right):**

Senior Exec (~17yr, \$127K)
Dev Advocate (~16yr, \$124K)
Manager (~15yr, \$116K)

SRE stands out:

Only ~10yr experience but \$99K median
— high pay relative to years worked

Student outlier (lower-left):

~2yr experience, \$15K median
— clear entry-level floor

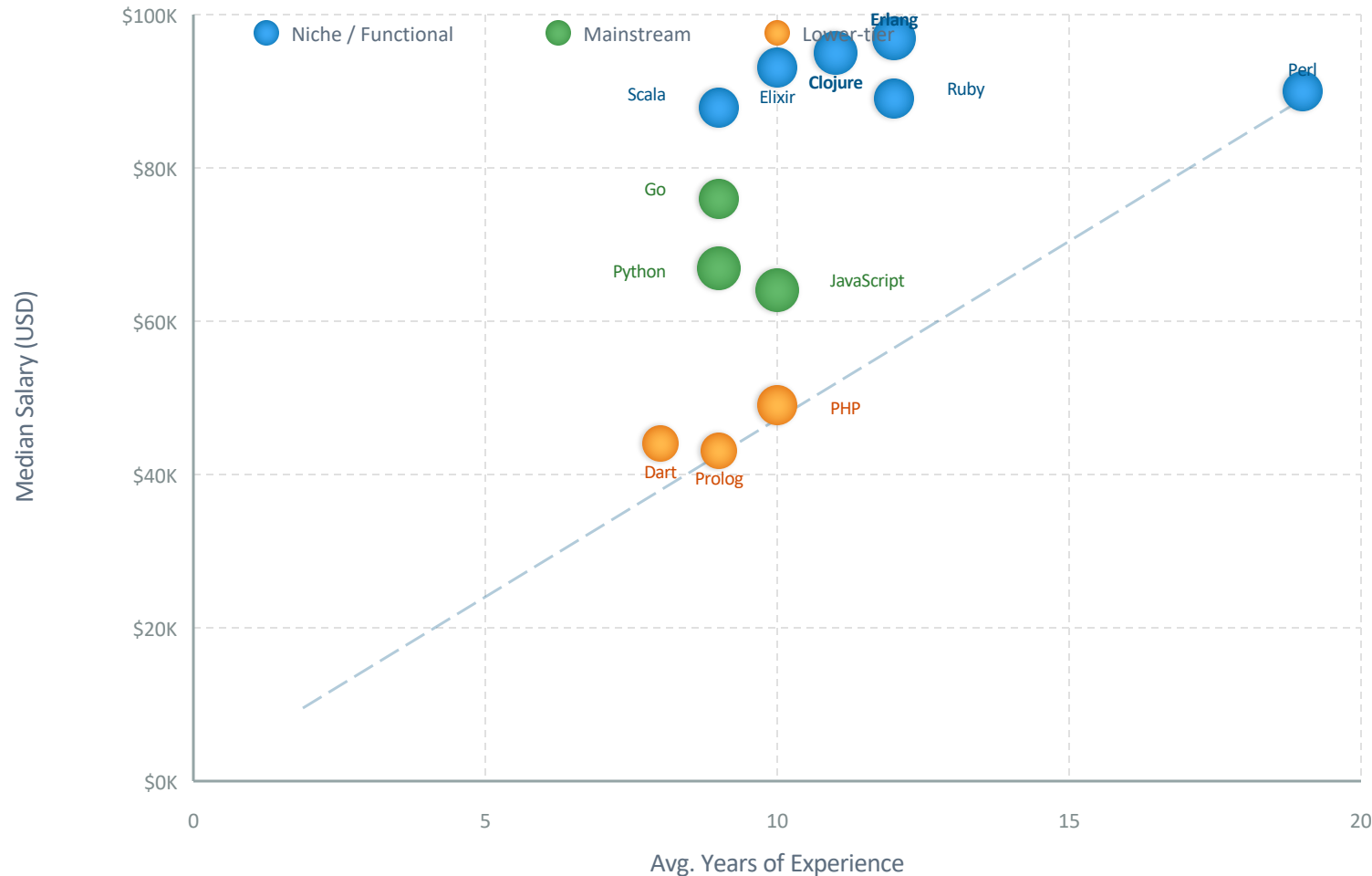
Experience-to-pay correlation:

Each additional year of experience
correlates with ~\$6-8K higher
median salary on average

Reference: See figure_2.jpg for original scatter plot

KEY INSIGHT

Niche functional languages pay 2x mainstream; overall salary range dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023 (\$60-75K vs. \$70-85K)

**Key Observations****Top earners (niche languages):**

Erlang ~\$97K (12yr exp)
Clojure ~\$95K (11yr exp)
Elixir ~\$93K (11yr exp)

Lowest earners:

Dart ~\$44K (8yr exp)
Prolog ~\$43K (9yr exp)
PHP ~\$49K (10yr exp)

YoY salary decline:

Average range dropped ~\$10K
2024: \$60-75K vs. 2023: \$70-85K

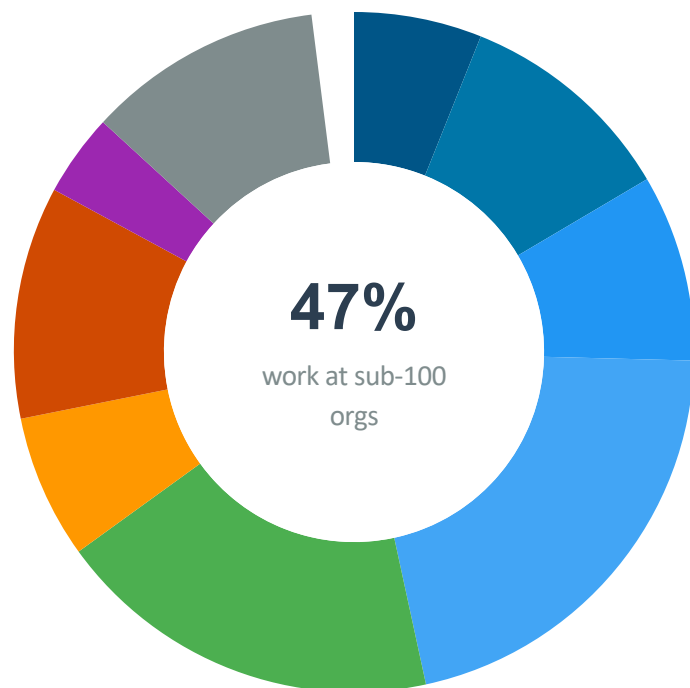
Perl anomaly:

Highest experience (~19yr) with
\$90K — veteran developers in
legacy systems command premium

Reference: See figure_3.jpg for original scatter plot

KEY INSIGHT

Developers are key purchase influencers — 62% have a say in tech buying, and 60% prefer a build-and-buy approach



Solo 6.1% 2-9 10.4% 10-19 8.9% 20-99 21.2% 100-499 18.5% 500-999 6.7%
1K-5K 11.0% 5K-10K 3.8% 10K+ 11.4%

Technology Purchasing Influence



Have Purchasing Influence

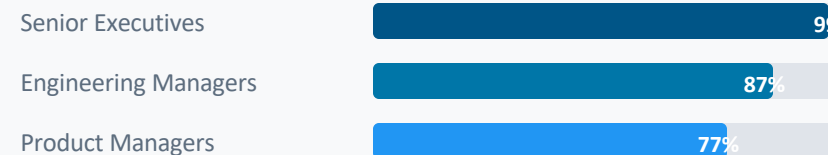
62%



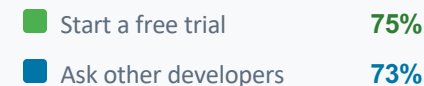
Prefer Build-and-Buy

60%

Who Influences Most?



How They Evaluate Tools



Vendor Takeaway

Target individual contributors directly — not just management — with free trials and peer reviews.

1

**Full-time employment is softening**

U.S. full-time employment dropped 4pp YoY — plan for more contractors and freelancers in your workforce mix.

Action: Build flexible staffing models that accommodate both full-time and contract talent.

2

**In-person mandates growing, but hybrid still dominant**

In-person rose from 15% to 20% over three years, yet 42% remain hybrid — flexibility is still key for retention.

Action: Design workplace policies for flexibility; don't mandate full return-to-office without data.

3

**DevRel and SRE roles command premium pay**

Dev Advocates (\$124K) and SREs (\$99K) top the chart — budget accordingly for these critical, hard-to-fill roles.

Action: Benchmark compensation for DevRel and SRE roles at or above market median to retain talent.

4

**Language choice correlates with pay — niche languages pay more**

Erlang and Clojure developers earn >\$95K — 2x mainstream languages like PHP (\$49K) and JavaScript (\$64K).

Action: When hiring for niche-language roles, expect higher salary expectations; cross-train existing staff.

5

**Most developers influence purchasing — engage them directly**

62% of developers have a say in tech buying; 75% evaluate via free trials, 73% ask peers. Target ICs, not just management.

Action: Invest in developer experience, free trials, and community advocacy as go-to-market channels.